Persist Week of March 9, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at **support@functional-bodybuilding.com**

We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.
This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x
- Monday March 9, 2026
- Tuesday March 10, 2026
- Wednesday March 11, 2026
- Thursday March 12, 2026
- Friday March 13, 2026
- Saturday March 14, 2026
- Sunday March 15, 2026
- Sunday Work In Lesson:

Pump Lift 4x
- Monday March 9, 2026
- Tuesday March 10, 2026
- Wednesday March 11, 2026
- Thursday March 12, 2026
- Friday March 13, 2026
- Saturday March 14, 2026
- Sunday March 15, 2026
- Sunday Work In Lesson:

Pump Lift 3x
- Monday March 9, 2026
- Tuesday March 10, 2026
- Wednesday March 11, 2026
- Thursday March 12, 2026
- Friday March 13, 2026
- Saturday March 14, 2026

- Sunday March 15, 2026
- Sunday Work In Lesson: Pump Condition 5x
- Monday March 9, 2026
- Tuesday March 10, 2026
- Wednesday March 11, 2026
- Thursday March 12, 2026
- Friday March 13, 2026
- Saturday March 14, 2026
- Sunday March 15, 2026
- Sunday Work In Lesson: Pump Condition 4x
- Monday March 9, 2026
- Tuesday March 10, 2026
- Wednesday March 11, 2026
- Thursday March 12, 2026
- Friday March 13, 2026
- Saturday March 14, 2026
- Sunday March 15, 2026
- Sunday Work In Lesson: Pump Condition 3x
- Monday March 9, 2026
- Tuesday March 10, 2026
- Wednesday March 11, 2026
- Thursday March 12, 2026
- Friday March 13, 2026
- Saturday March 14, 2026
- Sunday March 15, 2026
- Sunday Work In Lesson: Perform
- Monday March 9, 2026
- Tuesday March 10, 2026
- Wednesday March 11, 2026
- Thursday March 12, 2026
- Friday March 13, 2026
- Saturday March 14, 2026
- Sunday March 15, 2026

Sunday Work In Lesson: Minimalist
Monday March 9, 2026
Tuesday March 10, 2026
Wednesday March 11, 2026
Thursday March 12, 2026
Friday March 13, 2026
Saturday March 14, 2026
Sunday March 15, 2026
Sunday Work In Lesson:

Pump Lift 5x

Monday March 9, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Sumo Deadlift Focus
For the Sumo Deadlift today, dial in your positions during your warmup sets. Once your working sets start, it is all about consistent, perfect, high-speed reps. Let your body do the talking.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warm Up (8 min)
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Dual DB Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
Dual DB Bent Over Elbowing Row; 12 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
8 Working Sets; rest 45-60 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 2 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-8: 2 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:

This week, another increase in sets and decrease in reps. 8x2 will be performed around 85% of your 1RM, about 5% higher than week 3 weights. It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 16 reps. The goal is not to build to a 3 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 8 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Pendlay Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Increase weight each set. The reps have decreased from Week 3, allowing for an increase in weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
GHD Hip Extension or 45 Degree Hypers; 15 reps @30X0
rest 30-60 sec
Pronated Pull Up Negative; 3 reps @51A1 (see loading note)
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Weight may be added for the GHD Hip Extension or 45 Degree hyper, but aim to keep the technique perfect and tempo controlled. If you do not have access to either of these, you may perform the 45-degree alternative in the exercises swap section.
For the Pull Up Negative, the tempo is a 1 sec pause at the top and bottom with 5 second negative. Make sure that you have a box or bench near the Pull Up bar, so you can step or jump back up to the top position (A = Assist). The goal is to overload with more weight than you can normally do a Pull Up with. For some this may be just bodyweight, and for others you may have to add up to half your bodyweight.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2-3 Mechanical Drop Sets
DB Twist Curl; 8-10 reps @20X1
rest 10 sec
DB Hammer Curl; 8-10 reps @20X1

rest 2-3 min between sets

Loading Note:

A mechanical drop set is a training technique in which one set is performed with one weight and multiple position changes. Each position change should get more mechanically advantageous. In today's example, each bicep variation gets "easier" from a mechanical perspective.

G) Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets
Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday March 10, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Second Time Through
The second time through an exercise, the weight and movement pattern should feel more comfortable. This increased comfort should allow you to get even more out of it than the first time through, now that your mind and body have settled in together.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Seated Filly Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

Alternating DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Drop back to same weight as Set 1)

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
KB Horn Grip Raise; 8-10 reps @30X0
rest 30-60 sec
Offset Kettlebell Push Up; 5-8 reps/side @20X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2 Mechanical Drop Sets
DB Skullcrusher; 10 reps @20X0
rest 10 sec
DB Rolling Skullcrusher; 10 reps @20X0
rest 10 sec
DB Narrow Grip Bench Press; 10 reps @20X0
rest 90 secs between sets
Loading Note:
A mechanical drop set is a training technique in which one set is performed with one weight and multiple position changes. Each position change should get more mechanically advantageous. In today's example, each tricep variation gets "easier" from a mechanical perspective.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday March 11, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Tempo Progression
Every other week, you'll see a change in tempo to the squats. Changing the speed helps you improve your control and movement quality. Continuing to improve our movement quality is just as important as increasing weight or reps.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side
Theraband Hip Thrust; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
4 Working Sets; rest 90-120 seconds between
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 33X1 - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 44X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 9+
Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. The reps have decreased, but the time under tension (tempo) has increased. For your working sets, you'll take 4 seconds to get to the bottom, then hold tight for 4 seconds before exploding up (X). Pause 1 second at the top. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
1 1/4 Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X0 - RPE 9
Loading Note:

The 1/4 rep towards the top forces a lot of tension in the glutes and hamstrings and emphasizes a strong lockout of hip extension. The reps have decreased from Week 3, allowing for an increase in weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Hand Supported Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 6 reps/side @21X1
rest 30-60 sec
Single Leg Donkey Calf Raise; 10-15 reps/side @10X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform the KOT (Knee Over Toe) Split Squat for quality not load. This exercise is a great expression of full range of motion in the lower body. Use it to continue to improve your flexibility. Aim for close to failure with each set of calf raises.

F) Finisher (4-8 min):
Feet Anchored Sit Ups
8 sets
20 sec on; 10 sec
Loading Note:
Perform as many reps during the 20 seconds on. Take a 10-second break, then continue to perform as many reps as possible during the next block of 20 seconds. Continue for all sets. Compare to week 2 reps.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Thursday March 12, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min Run, Row, Bike, or Ski - Easy
At minutes 5, 15, 25, and 35, stop and perform:
12 V Up
12 Hollow Rocks
12 Tuck Up

20 sec Hollow Hold
At minutes 10, 20, and 30, stop and perform:
10 Side Plank Hip Taps Right
10 Side Plank Hip Taps Left
10 Beast to Alternating Leg Through
10 Underswitch To Crab Reach
This is a flow where you move continuously. Every 5 minutes you'll stop your easy pace cardio and go through a sequence of movements, then get back on the cardio until the next 5 minute mark.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Groins
Dynamic Adductor Stretch x 10 reps/side
Butterfly Stretch or Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 1-2 min
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side

Friday March 13, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Weighted Dips
It is easier to start cheating on your dip range of motion when the movement becomes more challenging. Make sure to emphasize full range of motion even as you start to add weight.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min)
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Offset Push Up; 6 reps/side
Banded Bent Over Row; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Every 60sec x 12 Sets
Odd Minutes - Weighted Strict Bar Dip x 4-6 reps @ 20X0
Even Minutes - Weighted Strict Neutral Grip Pull Up x 4-6 reps @ 20X0
Loading Note:
The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets. Finish the last 1-2 sets at RPE 9/10.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Curl; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (10-12 min):
2-3 sets
Incline DB Front Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Incline Rear Delt Swing; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Plank to Downdog; 10 controlled reps
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday March 14, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Giant Set
Changing the order of movements can be a subtle way to keep getting stronger in different ways. So the giant sets will sometimes change which type of movement you do first. For example, performing lunges before squats does not feel the same as performing lunges after squats. Which feels more comfortable for you?
Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side
Russian KBS; 10-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
DB Suitcase Cyclist Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Walking Lunges; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Suitcase Half Squat Pulses; 20-30 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one set of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Gliding Hamstring Curl; 10-12 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Ring Assisted Pistol Squat; 6 reps/side @ 20X0
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For the ring assisted Pistol Squat, you may hold onto any object that will act as a counterbalance and upper body support to keep the movement controlled and high quality. Perform a few reps of each movement to determine starting set up. Aim for each set to be RPE 8+.

E) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 15 sec
Hanging Leg Raise; 8-12 reps
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
The goal of this finisher is to build strength in some of the smaller muscles around the pelvis and the lower abdominals. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Sunday March 15, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

Detaching Self Worth From Output

It's easy to let numbers quietly define how we feel about ourselves. Weight on the bar. Times. Consistency streaks. These metrics help us see how things are trending - but they're never an end point that fully defines us.

Training is a practice that can show you how strong you are and make your weaknesses glaringly obvious. Seeing both should be expected. Just make sure you base your self worth on your inputs, rather than the outcomes. Did you show up the way you wanted to? If you did, you can feel proud no matter what.

If you measured success by effort and presence instead of performance, what would change about how you train this week?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday March 9, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Second Time Through
The second time through an exercise, the weight and movement pattern should feel more comfortable. This increased comfort should allow you to get even more out of it than the first time through, now that your mind and body have settled in together.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Seated Filly Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Alternating DB Bench Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES - Drop back to same weight as Set 1)

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets
KB Horn Grip Raise; 8-10 reps @30X0
rest 30-60 sec
Offset Kettlebell Push up; 5-8 reps/side @20X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2 Mechanical Drop Sets
DB Skullcrusher; 10 reps @20X0
rest 10 sec
DB Rolling Skullcrusher; 10 reps @20X0
rest 10 sec
DB Narrow Grip Bench Press; 10 reps @20X0
rest 90 secs between sets
Loading Note:
A mechanical drop set is a training technique in which one set is performed with one weight and multiple position changes. Each position change should get more mechanically advantageous. In today's example, each tricep variation gets "easier" from a mechanical perspective.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday March 10, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Sumo Deadlift Focus
For the Sumo Deadlift today, dial in your positions during your warmup sets. Once your working sets start, it is all about consistent, perfect, high-speed reps. Let your body do the talking.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets

Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side
Russian KBS; 10-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
8 Working Sets; rest 45-60 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 2 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-8: 2 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:
This week, another increase in sets and decrease in reps. 8x2 will be performed around 85% of your 1RM, about 5% higher than week 3 weights. It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 16 reps. The goal is not to build to a 3 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 8 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Pendlay Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Increase weight each set. The reps have decreased from Week 3, allowing for an increase in weight.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
DB Suitcase Cyclist Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Walking Lunges; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Suitcase Half Squat Pulses; 20-30 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:

For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one pair of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 15 sec
Hanging Leg Raise; 8-12 reps
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
The goal of this finisher is to build strength in some of the smaller muscles around the pelvis and the lower abdominals. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Wednesday March 11, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it. Or try a 30/30 Cardio workout in the Additional Resources section of the app.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Groins
Dynamic Adductor Stretch x 10 reps/side
Butterfly Stretch or Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 1-2 min
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side

Thursday March 12, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Weighted Dips
It is easier to start cheating on your dip range of motion when the movement becomes more challenging. Make sure to emphasize full range of motion even as you start to add weight.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Offset Push Up; 6 reps/side
Banded Bent Over Row; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Every 60sec x 12 Sets
Odd Minutes - Weighted Strict Bar Dip x 4-6 reps @ 20X0
Even Minutes - Weighted Strict Neutral Grip Pull Up x 4-6 reps @ 20X0
Loading Note:
The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets. Finish the last 1-2 sets at RPE 9/10.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Curl; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Incline DB Front Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Incline Rear Delt Swing; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Plank to Downdog; 10 controlled reps
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Friday March 13, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Tempo Progression
Every other week, you'll see a change in tempo to the squats. Changing the speed helps you improve your control and movement quality. Continuing to improve our movement quality is just as important as increasing weight or reps.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side
Theraband Hip Thrust; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat

4 Working Sets; rest 90-120 sec between
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 33X1 - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 44X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 9+

Loading Note:

Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. The reps have decreased, but the time under tension (tempo) has increased. For your working sets, you'll take 4 seconds to get to the bottom, then hold tight for 4 seconds before exploding up (X). Pause 1 second at the top. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
1 1/4 Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X0 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

The 1/4 rep towards the top forces a lot of tension in the glutes and hamstrings and emphasizes a strong lockout of hip extension. The reps have decreased from Week 3, allowing for an increase in weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Hand Supported Suitcase KOT Split Squat; 6 reps/side @21X1
rest 30-60 sec
Single Leg Donkey Calf Raise; 10-15 reps/side @10X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform the KOT (Knee Over Toe) Split Squat for quality not load. This exercise is a great expression of full range of motion in the lower body. Use it to continue to improve your flexibility. Aim for close to failure with each set of calf raises.

F) Finisher (4-8 min):
Feet Anchored Sit Ups

8 sets
20 sec on; 10 sec
Loading Note:
Perform as many reps during the 20 seconds on. Take a 10-second break, then continue to perform as many reps as possible during the next block of 20 seconds. Continue for all sets. Compare to G) week 2 reps.
Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Saturday March 14, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min Run, Row, Bike, or Ski - Easy
at minutes 5, 15, 25, and 35, stop and perform:
12 V Up
12 Hollow Rocks
12 Tuck Up
20 sec Hollow Hold
at minutes 10, 20, and 30, stop and perform:
10 Side Plank Hip Taps Right
10 Side Plank Hip Taps Left
10 Beast to Alternating Leg Through
10 Underswitch To Crab Reach
This is a flow where you move continuously. Every 5 minutes you'll stop your easy pace cardio and go through a sequence of movements, then get back on the cardio until the next 5 minute mark.
PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5 reps

Sunday March 15, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

Detaching Self Worth From Output

It's easy to let numbers quietly define how we feel about ourselves. Weight on the bar. Times. Consistency streaks. These metrics help us see how things are trending - but they're never an end point that fully defines us.

Training is a practice that can show you how strong you are and make your weaknesses glaringly obvious. Seeing both should be expected. Just make sure you base your self worth on your inputs, rather than the outcomes. Did you show up the way you wanted to? If you did, you can feel proud no matter what.

If you measured success by effort and presence instead of performance, what would change about how you train this week?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday March 9, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Sumo Deadlift Focus
For the Sumo Deadlift today, dial in your positions during your warmup sets. Once your working sets start, it is all about consistent, perfect, high-speed reps. Let your body do the talking.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warm Up (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Dual DB Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
Dual DB Bent Over Elbowing Row; 12 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):

Sumo Deadlift
8 Working Sets; rest 45-60 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 2 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-8: 2 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:
This week, another increase in sets and decrease in reps. 8x2 will be performed around 85% of your 1RM, about 5% higher than week 3 weights. It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 16 reps. The goal is not to build to a 3 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 8 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Seated Filly Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
DB Suitcase Cyclist Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Walking Lunges; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Suitcase Half Squat Pulses; 20-30 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one pair of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

F) Finisher (4-8 min):
Feet Anchored Sit Ups
8 sets
20 sec on; 10 sec
Loading Note:
Perform as many reps during the 20 seconds on. Take a 10-second break, then continue to perform as many reps as possible during the next block of 20 seconds. Continue for all sets. Compare to week 2 reps.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday March 10, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Groins
Dynamic Adductor Stretch x 10 reps/side
Butterfly Stretch or Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 1-2 min
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side

Wednesday March 11, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Complementary Exercises
A lot of exercises are programmed to work nicely alongside other exercises. The Hip Thrust in Strength Intensity 2 today serves exactly that purpose. You'll spend a lot of time in the bottom position of the squat this week. The hip thrust is a nice compliment to squatting and lunging. Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Offset Push Up; 6 reps/side
Banded Bent Over Row; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
1 1/4 Hip Thrust
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X0 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
The 1/4 rep towards the top forces a lot of tension in the glutes and hamstrings and emphasizes a strong lockout of hip extension. The reps have decreased from Week 3, allowing for an increase in weight.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Curl; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Incline DB Front Raise; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Incline Rear Delt Swing; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 10 sec
Plank to Downdog; 10 controlled reps
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5/side
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday March 12, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5 reps

Friday March 13, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: - Weighted Dips

It is easier to start cheating on your dip range of motion when the movement becomes more challenging. Make sure to emphasize full range of motion even as you start to add weight.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side
Theraband Hip Thrust; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
4 Working Sets; rest 90-120 sec
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 33X1 - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 44X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 9+
Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. The reps have decreased, but the time under tension (tempo) has increased. For your working sets, you'll take 4 seconds to get to the bottom, then hold tight for 4 seconds before exploding up (X). Pause 1 second at the top. RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Pendlay Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 @ 21X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Increase weight each set. The reps have decreased from Week 3, allowing for an increase in weight.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

Every 60sec x 12 Sets
Odd Minutes - Weighted Strict Bar Dip x 4-6 reps @ 20X0
Even Minutes - Weighted Strict Neutral Grip Pull Up x 4-6 reps @ 20X0
Loading Note:
The first three sets should be lighter or easier than the last three sets. Finish the last 1-2 sets at RPE 9/10.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 15 sec
Hanging Leg Raise; 8-12 reps
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
The goal of this finisher is to build strength in some of the smaller muscles around the pelvis and the lower abdominals. Keep quality high - you do not need to go to failure for a great stimulus in these muscles.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Saturday March 14, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min Run, Row, Bike, or Ski - Easy
at minutes 5, 15, 25, and 35, stop and perform:
12 V Up
12 Hollow Rocks
12 Tuck Up
20 sec Hollow Hold
at minutes 10, 20, and 30, stop and perform:
10 Side Plank Hip Taps Right
10 Side Plank Hip Taps Left
10 Beast to Alternating Leg Through
10 Underswitch To Crab Reach

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Front Splits
Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday March 15, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

Detaching Self Worth From Output

It's easy to let numbers quietly define how we feel about ourselves. Weight on the bar. Times. Consistency streaks. These metrics help us see how things are trending - but they're never an end point that fully defines us.

Training is a practice that can show you how strong you are and make your weaknesses glaringly obvious. Seeing both should be expected. Just make sure you base your self worth on your inputs, rather than the outcomes. Did you show up the way you wanted to? If you did, you can feel proud no matter what.

If you measured success by effort and presence instead of performance, what would change about how you train this week?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday March 9, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Sumo Deadlift Focus

For the Sumo Deadlift today, dial in your positions during your warmup sets. Once your working sets start, it is all about consistent, perfect, high-speed reps. Let your body do the talking.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Dual DB Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
Dual DB Bent Over Elbowing Row; 12 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
8 Working Sets; rest 45-60 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 2 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-8: 2 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:
This week, another increase in sets and decrease in reps. 8x2 will be performed around 85% of your 1RM, about 5% higher than week 3 weights. It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 18 reps. The goal is not to build to a 3 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 8 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
GHD Hip Extension or 45 Degree Hypers; 15 reps @30X0
rest 30-60 sec
Supinated Strict Pull Up; 8-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set of each movement to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7 on the first working set, and then increase weight each set, building up to RPE 9-10 on your last set.

E) Pull and Core Conditioning (12-15 min):
6min AMRAP (As Many Rounds/Reps As Possible)

1000/800m Bike Buy In (male/female)
-then in the time remaining-
2-4-6-8-10....(add 2 reps each round)
Split Stance KB Ballistic Row (R+L=1) 70/53# or 53/35#
*6 Alternating Plank Walk Up (3/side) between each round
rest 2 minutes and then repeat for a second 6-minute AMRAP
Effort Note:
Perform at a pace that you would self select for a 8-10 min AMRAP. This will make the 6 min AMRAP feel challenging, but sustainable enough to perform the second AMRAP with quality.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday March 10, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Second Time Through
The second time through an exercise, the weight and movement pattern should feel more comfortable. This increased comfort should allow you to get even more out of it than the first time through, now that your mind and body have settled in together.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Seated Filly Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
KB Horn Grip Raise; 8-10 reps @30X0
rest 30-60 sec
Offset Kettlebell Push up; 5-8 reps/side @20X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
4 Rounds For Time
3 Wall Walks or 6 Inchworm Push Ups
6 Kettlebell Snatch R 53/35# (male/female) or 35/26#
9 Feet Anchored Weighted Sit Up 53/35# or 35/26#
3 Wall Walks or 6 Inchworm Push Ups
6 Kettlebell Snatch L 53/35# or 35/26#
9 Feet Anchored Weighted Sit Up 53/35# or 35/26#
Effort Note:
The movements require a slow and steady grind for completion. To not hit failure too early into the workout on the upper body movements.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday March 11, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Tempo Progression
Every other week, you'll see a change in tempo to the squats. Changing the speed helps you improve your control and movement quality. Continuing to improve our movement quality is just as important as increasing weight or reps.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side
Theraband Hip Thrust; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
4 Working Sets; rest 90-120 seconds between
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 33X1 - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 44X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 9+
Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For your working sets, you'll take 4 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 4 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. The reps have decreased, but the time under tension (tempo) has increased. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1 1/4 Barbell Hip Thrust; 8 reps
rest 30-60 sec
Single Leg Donkey Calf Raise; 10-15 reps/side @10X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
6-10 Dumbbell Hang Power Cleans 50/35# (male/female)
6-8 Dumbbell Front Squats 50/35#

4-6 Dumbbell Thruster 50/35#
15-20 Cal Row
Effort Note:
The goal is to find reps and weights that allow you to finish these sets in around 3mins, giving you 1min to rest before you begin again. If you are unsure about how long this will take, then I recommend starting with the lower rep range and adding more reps or weight as you go if you are finishing too quickly and easily

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Thursday March 12, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min Run, Row, Bike, or Ski - Easy
At minutes 5, 15, 25, and 35, stop and perform:
12 V Up
12 Hollow Rocks
12 Tuck Up
20 sec Hollow Hold
At minutes 10, 20, and 30, stop and perform:
10 Side Plank Hip Taps Right
10 Side Plank Hip Taps Left
10 Beast to Alternating Leg Through
10 Underswitch To Crab Reach
This is a flow where you move continuously. Every 5 minutes you'll stop your easy pace cardio and go through a sequence of movements, then get back on the cardio until the next 5 minute mark.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Groins
Dynamic Adductor Stretch x 10 reps/side
Butterfly Stretch or Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 1-2 min
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side

Friday March 13, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Conditioning and Carries
I love to use carry variations in conditioning because it offers a place to catch your breath, while still getting meaningful strength work. This is great for hard charging personality types that have trouble pacing themselves. And it might allow you to bring more intensity and focus to other areas of the conditioning piece. Carries are also a staple for better shoulder stability.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Offset Pushup; 6 reps/side
Banded Bent Over Row; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Curl; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from Week 2 and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):

4 Sets @ high effort
15 KB Upright Rows @ 20X0
Row 10/8 Cal Sprint (male/female)
40m Filly Carry TOUGH (switch arms halfway)
rest walk 90-120sec between sets
Effort Note:
There are 3 phases to this conditioning format. Start with a high-quality Pull or Push for strength and hypertrophy. Then challenge your sprint capacity on the cardio. Finally, while breathing heavily, start your carry and move with great control.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday March 14, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Giant Set
Changing the order of movements can be a subtle way to keep getting stronger in different ways. So the giant sets will sometimes change which type of movement you do first. For example, performing lunges before squats does not feel the same as performing lunges after squats. Which feels more comfortable for you?
Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side
Russian KBS; 10-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
DB Suitcase Cyclist Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Walking Lunges; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec

Suitcase Half Squat Pulses; 20-30 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one set of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
For Time
Row 100/80 Cals (male/female)
60 Jump Lunges
100 Double Unders or 140 Single Unders
60 GHD Sit Ups OR Feet Anchored Sit Up
*20 min time cap.
Effort Note:
Bodyweight movements require lower muscle contraction, allowing you to continue to move under higher perception of fatigue. Try to not stop moving, even if you have to reduce the pace.

E) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Sunday March 15, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

Detaching Self Worth From Output

It's easy to let numbers quietly define how we feel about ourselves. Weight on the bar. Times. Consistency streaks. These metrics help us see how things are trending - but they're never an end point that fully defines us.

Training is a practice that can show you how strong you are and make your weaknesses glaringly obvious. Seeing both should be expected. Just make sure you base your self worth on your inputs, rather than the outcomes. Did you show up the way you wanted to? If you did, you can feel proud no matter what.

If you measured success by effort and presence instead of performance, what would change about how you train this week?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday March 9, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Second Time Through
The second time through an exercise, the weight and movement pattern should feel more comfortable. This increased comfort should allow you to get even more out of it than the first time through, now that your mind and body have settled in together.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Seated Filly Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 4-6 reps @31X2
rest 30sec

KB Horn Grip Raise; 8-10 reps @30X0
rest 30sec
Offset Kettlebell Push up; 5-8 reps/side @20X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
4 Rounds For Time
3 Wall Walks or 6 Inchworm Push Ups
6 Kettlebell Snatch R 53/35# (male/female) or 35/26#
9 Feet Anchored Weighted Sit Up 53/35# or 35/26#
3 Wall Walks or 6 Inchworm Push Ups
6 Kettlebell Snatch L 53/35# or 35/26#
9 Feet Anchored Weighted Sit Up 53/35# or 35/26#
Effort Note:
The movements require a slow and steady grind for completion. Try not to hit failure too early into the workout on the upper body movements.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
2) Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
3) Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday March 10, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Sumo Deadlift Focus
For the Sumo Deadlift today, dial in your positions during your warmup sets. Once your working sets start, it is all about consistent, perfect, high-speed reps. Let your body do the talking.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Dual DB Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
Dual DB Bent Over Elbowing Row; 12 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
8 Working Sets; rest 45-60 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 2 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-8: 2 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8

Loading Note:

This week, another increase in sets and decrease in reps. 8x2 will be performed around 85% of your 1RM, about 5% higher than week 3 weights. It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 16 reps. The goal is not to build to a 3 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 8 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
DB Suitcase Cyclist Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Walking Lunges; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Suitcase Half Squat Pulses; 20-30 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.

Loading Note:

For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one pair of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
For Time
Row 100/80 Cals (male/female)
60 Jump Lunges
100 Double Unders or 140 Single Unders
60 GHD Sit Ups OR Feet Anchored Sit Up
*20 min time cap.
Effort Note:

Bodyweight movements require lower muscle contraction, allowing you to continue to move under higher perception of fatigue. Try to not stop moving, even if you have to reduce the pace.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Wednesday March 11, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Groins
Dynamic Adductor Stretch x 10 reps/side
Butterfly Stretch or Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 1-2 min
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side

Thursday March 12, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Conditioning and Carries
I love to use carry variations in conditioning because it offers a place to catch your breath, while still getting meaningful strength work. This is great for hard charging personality types that have trouble pacing themselves. And it might allow you to bring more intensity and focus to other areas of the conditioning piece. Carries are also a staple for better shoulder stability.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Offset Pushup; 6 reps/side

Banded Bent Over Row; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Curl; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from Week 2 and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
4 Sets @ high effort
15 KB Upright Rows @20X0
Row 10/8 Cal Sprint (male/female)
40m Filly Carry TOUGH (switch arms halfway)
rest walk 90-120sec between sets
Effort Note:
There are 3 phases to this conditioning format. Start with a high-quality Pull or Push for strength and hypertrophy. Then challenge your sprint capacity on the cardio. Finally, while breathing heavily, start your carry and move with great control.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec

Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Friday March 13, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Tempo Progression
Every other week, you'll see a change in tempo to the squats. Changing the speed helps you improve your control and movement quality. Continuing to improve our movement quality is just as important as increasing weight or reps.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side
Russian KBS; 10-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
4 Working Sets; rest 90-120 seconds between
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 33X1 - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 44X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 9+
Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For your working sets, you'll take 4 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 4 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. The reps have decreased, but the time under tension (tempo) has increased. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1 1/4 Barbell Hip Thrust; 8 reps
rest 30-60 sec
Single Leg Donkey Calf Raise; 10-15 reps/side @10X0

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
6-10 Dumbbell Hang Power Cleans 50/35# (male/female)
6-8 Dumbbell Front Squats 50/35#
4-6 Dumbbell Thruster 50/35#
15-20 Cal Row
Effort Note:
The goal is to find reps and weights that allow you to finish these sets in around 3mins, giving you 1min to rest before you begin again. If you are unsure about how long this will take, then I recommend starting with the lower rep range and adding more reps or weight as you go if you are finishing too quickly and easily.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Saturday March 14, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min Run, Row, Bike, or Ski - Easy
at minutes 5, 15, 25, and 35, stop and perform:
12 V Up
12 Hollow Rocks
12 Tuck Up
20 sec Hollow Hold
at minutes 10, 20, and 30, stop and perform:
10 Side Plank Hip Taps Right
10 Side Plank Hip Taps Left
10 Beast to Alternating Leg Through
10 Underswitch To Crab Reach

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5 reps

Sunday March 15, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

Detaching Self Worth From Output

It's easy to let numbers quietly define how we feel about ourselves. Weight on the bar. Times. Consistency streaks. These metrics help us see how things are trending - but they're never an end point that fully defines us.

Training is a practice that can show you how strong you are and make your weaknesses glaringly obvious. Seeing both should be expected. Just make sure you base your self worth on your inputs, rather than the outcomes. Did you show up the way you wanted to? If you did, you can feel proud no matter what.

If you measured success by effort and presence instead of performance, what would change about how you train this week?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday March 9, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Supporting Player Shoulder Muscles

If you want a big bench, stronger pressing, and more Pull Ups, then work on improving the muscles that support your shoulders as well as your shoulders directly. The Strength Balance section includes some supporting muscle work with the goal of bringing more balance and capacity to the entire area.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Dual DB Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
Dual DB Bent Over Elbowing Row; 12 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
8 Working Sets; rest 45-60 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 2 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-8: 2 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:
This week, another increase in sets and decrease in reps. 8x2 will be performed around 85% of your 1RM, about 5% higher than last time in this cycle (Week 3). It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 18 reps. The goal is not to build to a 3 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 8 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 4-6 reps @31X2
rest 30sec
Seated Filly Press; 6 reps/side @30X0
rest 30sec
Offset Kettlebell Push up; 5-8 reps/side @20X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
For Time
Row 100/80 Cals (male/female)
60 Jump Lunges
100 Double Unders or 140 Single Unders
60 GHD Sit Ups OR Feet Anchored Sit Up
*20 min time cap.
Effort Note:
Bodyweight movements require lower muscle contraction, allowing you to continue to move under higher perception of fatigue. Try to not stop moving, even if you have to reduce the pace.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday March 10, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Groins
Dynamic Adductor Stretch x 10 reps/side
Butterfly Stretch or Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 1-2 min
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side

Wednesday March 11, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Conditioning and Carries

I love to use carry variations in conditioning because it offers a place to catch your breath, while still getting meaningful strength work. This is great for hard charging personality types that have trouble pacing themselves. And it might allow you to bring more intensity and focus to other areas of the conditioning piece. Carries are also a staple for better shoulder stability.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Offset Push Up; 6 reps/side
Banded Bent Over Row; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
DB Suitcase Cyclist Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Walking Lunges; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Suitcase Half Squat Pulses; 20-30 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one pair of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12-15 min):
4 Sets @ high effort

15 KB Upright Rows 20X0
Row 10/8 Cal Sprint (male/female)
40m Filly Carry TOUGH (switch arms halfway)
rest walk 90-120sec between sets
Effort Note:
There are 3 phases to this conditioning format. Start with a high-quality Pull or Push for strength and hypertrophy. Then challenge your sprint capacity on the cardio. Finally, while breathing heavily, start your carry and move with great control.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5/side
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Thursday March 12, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10-20 min):
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5 reps

Friday March 13, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Tempo Progression

Every other week, you'll see a change in tempo to the squats. Changing the speed helps you improve your control and movement quality. Continuing to improve our movement quality is just as important as increasing weight or reps.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side
Theraband Hip Thrust; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
4 Working Sets; rest 90-120 seconds between
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 33X1 - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 44X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 9+
Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For your working sets, you'll take 4 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 4 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. The reps have decreased, but the time under tension (tempo) has increased. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Curl; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from Week 2 and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
6-10 Dumbbell Hang Power Cleans 50/35# (male/female)
8-10 Dumbbell Thruster 50/35#
15-20 Cal Row
Effort Note:
The goal is to find reps and weights that allow you to finish these sets in around 3mins, giving you 1min to rest before you begin again. If you are unsure about how long this will take, then I recommend starting with the lower rep range and adding more reps or weight as you go if you are finishing too quickly and easily.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Saturday March 14, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min Run, Row, Bike, or Ski - Easy
at minutes 5, 15, 25, and 35, stop and perform:
12 V Up
12 Hollow Rocks
12 Tuck Up
20 sec Hollow Hold
at minutes 10, 20, and 30, stop and perform:
10 Side Plank Hip Taps Right
10 Side Plank Hip Taps Left
10 Beast to Alternating Leg Through
10 Underswitch To Crab Reach

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Front Splits
Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side

Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday March 15, 2026

Sunday Work In Lesson:

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

Detaching Self Worth From Output

It's easy to let numbers quietly define how we feel about ourselves. Weight on the bar. Times. Consistency streaks. These metrics help us see how things are trending - but they're never an end point that fully defines us.

Training is a practice that can show you how strong you are and make your weaknesses glaringly obvious. Seeing both should be expected. Just make sure you base your self worth on your inputs, rather than the outcomes. Did you show up the way you wanted to? If you did, you can feel proud no matter what.

If you measured success by effort and presence instead of performance, what would change about how you train this week?

With love,
Marcus

Perform

Monday March 9, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Sumo Deadlift Focus
For the Sumo Deadlift today, dial in your positions during your warmup sets. Once your working sets start, it is all about consistent, perfect, high-speed reps. Let your body do the talking.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice

Dual DB Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
Dual DB Bent Over Elbowing Row; 12 reps

C) HOT START (10-12 minutes):
4 Rounds Increasing Effort:
18/15 Calorie Row (male/female)
7 KB Split Snatch Right
7 KB Split Snatch Left
rest 45 sec between rounds
Effort Note:
Round 1 - Moderate
Round 2 - Hard
Round 3-4 - Very Tough Pace

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Sumo Deadlift
8 Working Sets; rest 45-60 sec between sets
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 21X1 - Moderate
Warm-Up Set - 2 reps @ 21X1 - Harder
Working Set 1-8: 2 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 6-8
Loading Note:
This week, another increase in sets and decrease in reps. 8x2 will be performed around 85% of your 1RM, about 5% higher than week 3 weights. It is important to stick close to this percentage as the rest is shorter and the goal of this session is to keep quality and speed high throughout all 16 reps. The goal is not to build to a 3 rep max. Select a weight that is about an RPE 6-7 on the first working set, and then keep this weight the same for all 8 sets. As sets go on, the fatigue accumulated will increase the difficulty and thus RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
GHD Hip Extension or 45 Degree Hypers; 15 reps @30X0
rest 30-60 sec
Supinated Strict Pull Up; 8-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set of each movement to determine starting weight. Aim for RPE 7 on the first working set, and then increase weight each set, building up to RPE 9-10 on your last set.

F) Pull Conditioning (12-15 min):
6min AMRAP (As Many Rounds/Reps As Possible)
1000/800m Bike Buy In (male/female)
-then in the time remaining-
2-4-6-8-10....(add 2 reps each round)
Hang Power Clean (115/85#)
Burpee Over Bar
rest 2 minutes and then repeat for a second 6-minute AMRAP
Effort Note:
Perform at a pace that you would self select for a 8-10 min AMRAP. This will make the 6 min AMRAP feel challenging, but sustainable enough to perform the second AMRAP with quality.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Lumbar Roll to Pancake Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
Single Arm Wall Prayer Stretch x 30 sec/side
Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday March 10, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Second Time Through
The second time through an exercise, the weight and movement pattern should feel more comfortable. This increased comfort should allow you to get even more out of it than the first time through, now that your mind and body have settled in together.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
Banded YTW; 5-7 reps in each position

C) Dip + Core + Shoulder Prefatigue (12 min):
3 Working Sets

Strict Bar or Ring Dip; 6-8 reps @21X1
directly into
Dip Support Tuck L Sit or Dip Support L Sit; 15-30 sec
rest 15sec
Powell Raise; 10-12 reps/side
rest 90sec between sets
Effort Note:
Increase intensity each set. Start on the lower end of the reps (with less weight on the DB) and then increase weight and reps.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Seated Filly Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
KB Horn Grip Raise; 8-10 reps @30X0
rest 30-60 sec
Offset Kettlebell Push up; 5-8 reps/side @20X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Upper Body Conditioning (15 min):
3:30 AMCAP (As Many Calories As Possible) x 3 Sets:
Buy In:
16-12-8
Deficit Push Ups
Alternating DB Snatch (50/35#) (R+L=2)
*Then in remaining time:
Bike as many Calories as Possible
rest 90 sec between sets
Effort Note:

Use lighter weights and/or scale the Push Ups if you need more time to bike. Try to leave yourself about 60-90 seconds of biking each round.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Sidelying 90/90 Thoracic Rotation; 5 reps/side
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday March 11, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Tempo Progression
Every other week, you'll see a change in tempo to the squats. Changing the speed helps you improve your control and movement quality. Continuing to improve our movement quality is just as important as increasing weight or reps.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Curtsy Squat; 8 reps/side
Theraband Hip Thrust; 15-20 reps

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift
10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
+
Every 2:00 x 5 sets
2 Pause at Knee Snatch
rest until the next 2:00

Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
4 Working Sets; rest 90-120 seconds between sets
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 33X1 - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 3 reps @ 44X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - 2 @ 44X1 - RPE 9+
Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For your working sets, you'll take 4 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 4 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. The reps have decreased, but the time under tension (tempo) has increased. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1 1/4 Barbell Hip Thrust; 8 reps
rest 30-60 sec
Single Leg Donkey Calf Raise; 10-15 reps/side @10X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

F) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
For Time
Row 100/80 Cals (male/female)
60 Jump Lunges (30/side)
60 GHD Sit Ups OR Feet Anchored Sit Up
60 Air Squats
*20 min time cap.
Effort Note:

Bodyweight movements require lower muscle contraction, allowing you to continue to move under higher perception of fatigue. Try to not stop moving, even if you have to reduce the pace.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Thursday March 12, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min Run, Row, Bike, or Ski - Easy
at minutes 5, 15, 25, and 35, stop and perform:
12 V Up
12 Hollow Rocks
12 Tuck Up
20 sec Hollow Hold
at minutes 10, 20, and 30, stop and perform:
10 Side Plank Hip Taps Right
10 Side Plank Hip Taps Left
10 Beast to Alternating Leg Through
10 Underswitch To Crab Reach

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Groins
Dynamic Adductor Stretch x 10 reps/side
Butterfly Stretch or Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 1-2 min
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side

Friday March 13, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Conditioning and Carries

I love to use carry variations in conditioning because it offers a place to catch your breath, while still getting meaningful strength work. This is great for hard charging personality types that have trouble pacing themselves. And it might allow you to bring more intensity and focus to other areas of the conditioning piece. Carries are also a staple for better shoulder stability.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Offset Pushup; 6 reps/side
Banded Bent Over Row; 15-20 reps

C) Gymnastics HOT START (10-12 min):
Every 3:00 x 4-5 sets
12/10 Cal Row @ HIGH Effort (male/female)
5 Strict L Pull Up or 5 Strict Tuck Pull Up
50' HS Walk or 4 Wall Walks
5 Strict L Pullup or 5 Strict Tuck Pull Up
Effort Note:
Adjust pace as needed to prioritize high quality reps on the gymnastics movements.

D) Strength Intensity (15 min):
1 1/4 Close-Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set - 4 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Remove the 1/4 Rep and perform Max reps of Close-Grip Bench Press @ Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
Barbell Curl; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1

Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from Week 2 and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

F) GRINDER Conditioning (12 min):
For Time @ Sustainable Pace
8 Alternating Turkish Get Ups 53/35# or 35/26#
50m Right Arm Single Arm Farmers Carry 53/35# or 35/26#
50m Left Arm Single Arm Farmers Carry 53/35# or 35/26#
500/400m Bike (male/female)
8 Alternating Turkish Get Ups 53/35# or 35/26#
500/400m Bike
50m Right Arm Single Arm Farmers Carry 53/35# or 35/26#
50m Left Arm Single Arm Farmers Carry 53/35# or 35/26#
8 Alternating Turkish Get Ups 53/35# or 35/26#
*Time Cap - 12mins
Effort Note:
These conditioning pieces are exploring challenging KB weights and movements like the GetUp and the Windmill over this 6-week cycle. Move at a controlled pace and slow down to make sure you execute the more complex movements correctly.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Saturday March 14, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Giant Set
Changing the order of movements can be a subtle way to keep getting stronger in different ways. So the giant sets will sometimes change which type of movement you do first. For example, performing lunges before squats does not feel the same as performing lunges after squats. Which feels more comfortable for you?
Short on Time? Perform 2 sets of Strength Intensity 1.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice

+
3 Sets
Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side
Russian KBS; 10-15 reps

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15 min):
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Romanian Deadlift
10 Strict Press
10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold
10 sec Front Squat Hold
+
5 sets; rest 90 sec between sets
2 Full Clean + 2 Front Squats
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity Giant Set (18 min):
4 sets
DB Suitcase Cyclist Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Walking Lunges; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Suitcase Half Squat Pulses; 20-30 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one set of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure).

E) Alphabet Soup (20-25 minutes):
4 Sets:
A. 15 Dual KB Clean from Floor 53/35# (male/female)
B. 10 Box Jump Step Down 30/24"
C. 15-20 Cal Bike
D. 20 Wall Balls 20/14# to 10'

E. 15 GHD Sit Ups or 20 Anchored Sit Ups
rest walk 2mins
Effort note:
Changing the exercise order each set requires good pacing and a better understanding of the demands of each individual movement. Follow this order:
Set 1 - ABCDE
Set 2 - EDCBA
Set 3 - CDEAB
Set 4 - BAEDC

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Sunday March 15, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM

Detaching Self Worth From Output

It's easy to let numbers quietly define how we feel about ourselves. Weight on the bar. Times. Consistency streaks. These metrics help us see how things are trending - but they're never an end point that fully defines us.

Training is a practice that can show you how strong you are and make your weaknesses glaringly obvious. Seeing both should be expected. Just make sure you base your self worth on your inputs, rather than the outcomes. Did you show up the way you wanted to? If you did, you can feel proud no matter what.

If you measured success by effort and presence instead of performance, what would change about how you train this week?

With love,
Marcus

Minimalist

Monday March 9, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Second Time Through
The second time through an exercise, the weight and movement pattern should feel more comfortable. This increased comfort should allow you to get even more out of it than the first time through, now that your mind and body have settled in together.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
DB Windmill; 5 reps/side
Prone Swimmers; 30 sec

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Seated DB Filly Press
3 Working Sets; rest 90 sec
Warm-Up Set - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @ 21X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps/side @ 20X0 - RPE 10 (NO PAUSES once you start each arm - Same weight as Set 2)
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 4-6 reps @31X2
rest 30sec
DB Lateral Raise; 8-10 reps @30X0
rest 30sec
Offset Push up; 5-8 reps/side @20X1
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Upper Body Grinder (15 min time cap):
4 Rounds For Time
3 Wall Walks or 6 Inchworm Push Ups
6 Kettlebell Snatch R 53/35# (male/female) or 35/26#
9 Feet Anchored Weighted Sit Up 53/35# or 35/26#
3 Wall Walks or 6 Inchworm Push Ups
6 Kettlebell Snatch L 53/35# (male/female) or 35/26#
9 Feet Anchored Weighted Sit Up 53/35# or 35/26#
Effort Note:
The movements require a slow and steady grind for completion. Try not hit failure too early into the workout on the upper body movements.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side
Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Tuesday March 10, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Sumo Deadlift Warmup
The warmup for deadlifts and squats are very important to dial in all the appropriate positions, so that when you start your first working set you are firing on all cylinders.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning

B) Warm Up (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Dual DB Sumo Deadlift High Pull; 8 reps
Dual DB Bent Over Elbowing Row; 12 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Sumo Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min between sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 21X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps @ 21X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:

The tempo prescription for today has a brief pause in the bottom position, emphasizing control in the most challenging position.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
DB Suitcase Cyclist Squat; 6-8 reps @22X1
rest 30 sec
DB Suitcase Walking Lunges; 10 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Suitcase Half Squat Pulses; 20-30 sec
rest 2 min and back to 1.

Loading Note:

For this lower body giant set, the goal is to use one pair of DBs for each set. Perform 1 warmup set to determine starting weight. Aim for the first set to be around RPE 7. Increase weight each set with the goal of an increasing RPE.

E) Lower Body Conditioning (15-20 min):
For Time
800m Run
60 Jump Lunges
100 Double Unders or 140 Single Unders
60 Feet Anchored Sit Up
*20 min time cap.
Effort Note:
Bodyweight movements require lower muscle contraction, allowing you to continue to move under higher perception of fatigue. Try to not stop moving, even if you have to reduce the pace.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Slantboard Jefferson Pulse; 30 sec
Half Kneeling Hip Flexor Stretch; 30 sec/side
Shinbox Heel Touch; 5 reps/side

Wednesday March 11, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min): Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Groins
Dynamic Adductor Stretch x 10 reps/side
Butterfly Stretch or Weighted Butterfly Stretch x 1-2 min
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Middle Split x 1-2 min
Cossack Squat x 5 reps/side

Thursday March 12, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Conditioning and Carries
I love to use carry variations in conditioning because it offers a place to catch your breath, while still getting meaningful strength work. This is great for hard charging personality types that have trouble pacing themselves. And it might allow you to bring more intensity and focus to other areas of the conditioning piece. Carries are also a staple for better shoulder stability.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Offset Push Up; 6 reps/side
Banded Bent Over Row; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Narrow Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 12 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max reps of Narrow Bench Press @ Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets
Dual DB Bicep Curl; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 6-8 reps @30X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure. Reps have decreased from Week 2 and time under tension (tempo) has increased.

E) Push Pull Sprint (12 min):
12min Continuous Clock
8-12 Narrow Grip Push Up
12-16 Alternating DB Snatch From Floor 50/35# (male/female) or 35/20#
20m per arm Single Arm DB Overhead Carry 50/35# (male/female) or 35/20#
5 Shuttle Run
*Shuttle Run: Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Forward Shoulder Wall Circles; 10 reps/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion Stretch; 30 sec
Banded Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30 sec

Friday March 13, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Tempo Progression
Every other week, you'll see a change in tempo to the squats. Changing the speed helps you improve your control and movement quality. Continuing to improve our movement quality is just as important as increasing weight or reps.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance or Conditioning.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Long Split Pulse; 15 sec/side
DB Swings; 10-15 reps

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
DB Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 5 reps @ 44X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 5 @ 44X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 @ 44X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 @ 44X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Prioritize a quality pause and bottom position during all sets today. For your working sets, you'll take 4 seconds to get down into the bottom position, hold tight for 4 seconds at the bottom, explode up (X), then pause for 1 second at the top. The reps have decreased, but the time under tension (tempo) has increased. Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1 1/4 DB Hip Thrust; 8 reps
rest 30-60 sec
Single Leg Donkey Calf Raise; 10-15 reps/side @10X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set for each movement to determine the starting weight. Aim for the first set to be RPE 7 and then increase weight each set.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12 min):
Every 4mins x 3 Sets
6-10 Dumbbell Hang Power Cleans 50/35# (male/female)
6-8 Dumbbell Front Squats 50/35#
4-6 Dumbbell Thruster 50/35#
Run 150m
Effort Note:
The goal is to find reps and weights that allow you to finish these sets in around 3mins, giving you 1min to rest before you begin again. If you are unsure about how long this will take, then I recommend starting with the lower rep range and adding more reps or weight as you go if you are finishing too quickly and easily.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Half Split Hip Hinge; 6-8 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch; 30 sec/side

Bottom of Squat Hold; 30 sec

Saturday March 14, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
40 min Run, Row, Bike, or Ski - Easy
at minutes 5, 15, 25, and 35, stop and perform:
12 V Up
12 Hollow Rocks
12 Tuck Up
20 sec Hollow Hold
at minutes 10, 20, and 30, stop and perform:
10 Side Plank Hip Taps Right
10 Side Plank Hip Taps Left
10 Beast to Alternating Leg Through
10 Underswitch To Crab Reach

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
Prone Shoulder Swimmers (Blackburns) x 5 reps

Sunday March 15, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist MINIMALIST

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